The Tree Beyond the Trees

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 1

Lookout Hill's invitation lay beside a borrowed guide. The woodland post route was working behind you; the complete old map and moonstone remained at camp. On the hill path, Nib chose the first convenient tree. Lark compared its rounded crown with the forked silhouette in the guide. They were plainly different trees.

“A tree is a tree,” Nib declared hopefully. “This word asks us to see a particular one,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **stamp**

“Two e letters can work together for the long e sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read see and seed with one vowel sound for ee. Compare the short e in pen. In tree, blend the beginning sounds together before adding ee.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try see, seed, feet, tree. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tree in the route key,” Lark invited gently. “Which distant silhouette matches the whole guide clue?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can see. Pat can see tree tops.**

“What can Pat see?” Lark asked gently. “Read all the words after can.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

From a broad viewing stump, the forked tree showed above the near canopy. Lark traced the correct path in the guide. Nib stepped away from his convenient trunk and followed the useful direction instead. At a supply shelter, the lookout's glass fittings waited in padded storage. They had found the route without inventing a new map.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write see beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the two tree shapes on your first hill journal page. The guide stayed with the crew. The next job was bringing the waiting glass and its small fittings uphill in one piece.